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2. Lactic acid fermentation

Some bacteria (*Bacillus*), fungi and muscles of vertebrates produce lactic acid from pyruvic acid (Table 14.3).

$$2CH_3COCOOH + 2NADH + 2H^+ \xrightarrow[\text{Lactate dehydrogenase}]{\text{Pyruvic acid}} 2CH_3CHOHCOOH + 2NAD^+$$

Lactic acid

3. Mixed acid fermentation

This type of fermentation is a characteristic feature of Enterobacteriaceae and results in the formation of lactic acid, ethanol, formic acid and gases like CO_2 and H_2.

Characteristics of Anaerobic Respiration

1. Anaerobic respiration is less efficient than the aerobic respiration (Figure 14. 12) (Table 14.4).
2. Limited number of ATP molecules is generated per glucose molecule (Table 14.5).
3. It is characterized by the production of CO_2 and it is used for Carbon fixation in photosynthesis.

Table 14.4: Comparison between glycolysis and fermentation

Glycolysis	Fermentation
1. Glucose is converted into pyruvic acid.	Starts from pyruvic acid and is converted into alcohol or lactic acid.
2. It takes place in the presence or absence of oxygen.	It takes place in the absence of oxygen.
3. Net gain is 2ATP.	No net gain of ATP molecules.
4. 2NADH + H^+ molecules are produced.	2NADH + H^+ molecules are utilised.

Table 14.5: Net products from one molecule of Glucose under Glycolysis and Anaerobic respiration.

Stage	Substrate level ATP production	Reduced NAD^+	Total ATP
Glycolysis	2	2*	8
Anaerobic respiration	2	2 reduced NAD^+ re-oxidised	2

*One reduced NAD^+ equivalent to 3 ATPs

Check your grasp!

- Why Microorganisms respire anaerobically?
- Does anaerobic respiration take place in higher plants?

Demonstration of alcoholic fermentation

Take a Kuhne's fermentation tube which consists of an upright glass tube with side bulb. Pour 10% sugar solution mixed with baker's yeast into the fermentation tube the side tube is filled plug the mouth with lid. After some time, the glucose solution will be fermented. The solution will give out an alcoholic smell and level of solution in glass column will fall due to the accumulation of CO_2 gas. It is due to the presence of zymase enzyme in yeast which converts the glucose solution into alcohol and CO_2. Now introduce a pellet of KOH into the tube, the KOH will absorb CO_2 and the level of solution will rise in upright tube (Figure 14.13).